AI Superpowers: China, Silicon Valley, and the New World Order

Kai-Fu Lee

1. The rise of deep learning, spearheaded by Geoffrey Hinton’s breakthroughs in the mid-2000s, revolutionized AI by significantly enhancing neural networks' performance in tasks like speech and object recognition. Despite initial resistance within the AI community, deep learning emerged as a dominant paradigm after 2012, when Hinton’s neural network triumphed in a global computer vision contest. However, this progress is limited to "narrow AI," capable of optimizing within specific domains, far from the versatility of "general AI." The book illustrates how deep learning exemplifies a transition in AI from groundbreaking discoveries to practical implementations.

2. Kai-Fu Lee emphasizes China’s unique position in the AI revolution, benefiting from its vast data resources, enterprising culture, and government support. This advantage is underscored by China’s transition from copycat entrepreneurship to indigenous innovation, which thrives on mobile-first ecosystems, super-apps like WeChat, and cashless urban environments. The abundance of user data collected from real-world activities gives Chinese AI firms an edge in creating highly optimized solutions. In contrast, Silicon Valley focuses on data derived from online behavior, revealing the contrasting strengths of the two tech giants.

3. The book identifies four waves of AI transformation: Internet AI, Business AI, Perception AI, and Autonomous AI. Internet AI leverages algorithms to recommend content tailored to user preferences, while Business AI optimizes processes like loan approvals with unprecedented precision. Perception AI digitizes physical environments using smart devices, creating seamless integration of AI into daily life. Autonomous AI represents the culmination of these technologies, enabling machines to both understand and shape the world. China’s aggressive policymaking and vast data ecosystem position it as a strong contender in these waves.

4. Lee critiques the monopolistic tendencies of AI-driven industries, where data advantages compound, leading to insurmountable barriers for competitors. This winner-take-all dynamic could exacerbate income inequality and job displacement, as automation threatens even high-skilled professions. The book predicts significant societal disruptions as AI outpaces traditional labor systems, accelerating the concentration of wealth in a few corporate entities. Lee warns that unchecked AI could deepen global inequality and destabilize political systems.

5. The economic ramifications of AI extend globally, with estimates suggesting it will contribute $15.7 trillion to GDP by 2030, with China reaping nearly half of this growth. However, the automation of factories and services threatens to dismantle the traditional economic ladders of developing nations. This shift could further widen the gap between wealthy and impoverished regions. Lee stresses that the key to navigating this transformation lies in leveraging AI for human benefit rather than perpetuating inequality.

6. Addressing the potential fallout of AI-driven unemployment, the book explores solutions like Universal Basic Income (UBI) but critiques it as a superficial fix. Instead, Lee advocates for a "social investment stipend" to reward activities that foster compassion, creativity, and community. This proposal aims to create a more equitable AI economy by supporting human-centered jobs and service-based industries. Such measures could mitigate the social and economic upheavals anticipated in the AI age.

7. China’s rapid development in AI is fueled by a combination of heavy venture capital investment and government intervention. While critics argue that such approaches lead to inefficiencies, Lee highlights their effectiveness in achieving long-term innovation. Chinese startups have pioneered online-to-offline (O2O) services and transformed urban environments, setting a global precedent for integrating technology into daily life. These developments exemplify how China is redefining the rules of innovation in the AI era.

8. The book also delves into the ethical and philosophical implications of AI, emphasizing the need for a shift in societal values. Lee suggests moving away from a mindset that equates work with personal worth and toward one that prioritizes human connection and service. He underscores the importance of designing AI systems that complement human creativity and compassion rather than replacing them. Such a reimagining of AI’s role in society could pave the way for a more harmonious coexistence between humans and machines.

9. Lee underscores the transformative potential of AI in various industries, from healthcare to education and law. For example, AI-powered diagnostic tools and courtroom assistants can democratize access to high-quality services while improving efficiency. However, he cautions against over-reliance on technology, advocating for human oversight to maintain ethical standards. By integrating AI responsibly, society can harness its benefits while minimizing potential harms.

10. Concluding on a reflective note, Lee acknowledges the extraordinary advancements AI has achieved but questions its ultimate purpose. He suggests that the true measure of progress lies not in outperforming human intelligence but in understanding and enhancing the human heart. This philosophical perspective calls for a balanced approach to AI development, one that aligns technological innovation with humanity's core values. Lee’s vision challenges readers to think beyond economic gains and consider the profound impact of AI on our shared future.

Excerpts

Stelle: 211

Deep learning’s big technical break finally arrived in the mid-2000s, when leading researcher Geoffrey Hinton discovered a way to efficiently train those new layers in neural networks. The result was like giving steroids to the old neural networks, multiplying their power to perform tasks such as speech and object recognition. Soon, these juiced-up neural networks—now rebranded as “deep learning”—could outperform older models at a variety of tasks. But years of ingrained prejudice against the neural networks approach led many AI researchers to overlook this “fringe” group that claimed outstanding results. The turning point came in 2012, when a neural network built by Hinton’s team demolished the competition in an international computer vision contest.

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Stelle: 229

Deep learning is what’s known as “narrow AI”—intelligence that takes data from one specific domain and applies it to optimizing one specific outcome. While impressive, it is still a far cry from “general AI,” the all-purpose technology that can do everything a human can.

Notiz

Stelle: 253

The West may have sparked the fire of deep learning, but China will be the biggest beneficiary of the heat the AI fire is generating. That global shift is the product of two transitions: from the age of discovery to the age of implementation, and from the age of expertise to the age of data.

Notiz

Stelle: 295

Harnessing the power of AI today—the "electricity" of the twenty-first century—requires four analogous inputs: abundant data, hungry entrepreneurs, AI scientists, and an AI-friendly policy environment. By looking at the relative strengths of China and the United States in these four categories, we can predict the emerging balance of power in the AI world order.

Notiz

Stelle: 298

Both of the transitions described on the previous pages—from discovery to implementation, and from expertise to data—now tilt the playing field toward China. They do this by minimizing China's weaknesses and amplifying its strengths. Moving from discovery to implementation reduces one of China's greatest weak points (outside-the-box approaches to research questions) and also leverages the country's most significant strength: scrappy entrepreneurs with sharp instincts for building robust businesses. The transition from expertise to data has a similar benefit, downplaying the importance of the globally elite researchers that China lacks and maximizing the value of another key resource that China has in abundance, data.

Notiz

Stelle: 315

The messy markets and dirty tricks of China's "copycat" era produced some questionable companies, but they also incubated a generation of the world's most nimble, savvy, and nose-to-the-grindstone entrepreneurs.

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Stelle: 336

China's alternate digital universe now creates and captures oceans of new data about the real world. That wealth of information on users—their location every second of the day, how they commute, what foods they like, when and where they buy groceries and beer—will prove invaluable in the era of AI implementation.

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Stelle: 355

PricewaterhouseCoopers estimates AI deployment will add $15.7 trillion to global GDP by 2030. China is predicted to take home $7 trillion of that total, nearly double North America's $3.7 trillion in gains. As the economic balance of power tilts in China's favor, so too will political influence and "soft power," the country's cultural and ideological footprint around the globe.

Notiz

Stelle: 369

Based on the current trends in technology advancement and adoption, I predict that within fifteen years, artificial intelligence will technically be able to replace around 40 to 50 percent of jobs in the United States. Actual job losses may end up lagging those technical capabilities by an additional decade, but I forecast that the disruption to job markets will be very real, very large, and coming soon.

Notiz

Stelle: 381

In the past, the dominance of physical goods and limits of geography helped rein in consumer monopolies. (U.S. antitrust laws didn't hurt either.) But going forward, digital goods and services will continue eating up larger shares of the consumer pie, and autonomous trucks and drones will dramatically slash the cost of shipping physical goods. Instead of a dispersion of industry profits across different companies and regions, we will begin to see greater and greater concentration of these astronomical sums in the hands of a few, all while unemployment lines grow longer.

Notiz

Stelle: 392

AI-driven automation in factories will undercut the one economic advantage developing countries historically possessed: cheap labor. Robot-operated factories will likely relocate to be closer to their customers in large markets, pulling away the ladder that developing countries like China and the "Asian Tigers" of South Korea and Singapore climbed up on their way to becoming high-income, technology-driven economies. The gap between the global haves and have-nots will widen, with no known path toward closing it. The AI world order will combine winner-take-all economics with an unprecedented concentration of wealth in the hands of a few companies in China and the United States. This, I believe, is the real underlying threat posed by artificial intelligence: tremendous social disorder and political collapse stemming from widespread unemployment and gaping inequality.

Notiz

Stelle: 510

Combine these three currents—a cultural acceptance of copying, a scarcity mentality, and the willingness to dive into any promising new industry—and you have the psychological foundations of China's internet ecosystem.

Notiz

Stelle: 697

While foreign analysts continued to harp on the question of why American companies couldn't win in China, Chinese companies were busy building better products. Weibo, a micro-blogging platform initially inspired by Twitter, was far faster to expand multimedia functionality and is now worth more than the American company. Didi, the ride-hailing company that duked it out with Uber, dramatically expanded its product offerings and gives more rides each day in China than Uber does across the entire world. Toutiao, a Chinese news platform often likened to BuzzFeed, uses advanced machine-learning algorithms to tailor its content for each user, boosting its valuation many multiples above the American website. Dismissing these companies as copycats relying on government protection in order to succeed blinds analysts to world-class innovation that is happening elsewhere.

Notiz

Stelle: 913

around 2013, the Chinese internet changed direction. It no longer lagged behind the Western internet in functionality, though it also hadn't surpassed Silicon Valley on its own terms. Instead, it was morphing into an alternate internet universe, a space with its own raw materials, planetary systems, and laws of physics. It was a place where many users accessed the internet only through cheap smartphones, where smartphones played the role of credit cards, and where population-dense cities created a rich laboratory for blending the digital and physical worlds.

Notiz

Stelle: 920

Underneath this transformation lay several key building blocks: mobile-first internet users, WeChat's role as the national super-app, and mobile payments that transformed every smartphone into a digital wallet. Once those pieces were in place, Chinese startups set off an explosion of indigenous innovation. They pioneered online-to-offline services that stitched the internet deep into the fabric of the Chinese economy. They turned Chinese cities into the first cashless environments since the days of the barter economy. And they revolutionized urban transportation with intelligent bike-sharing applications that created the world's largest internet-of-things network.

Notiz

Stelle: 954

Silicon Valley juggernauts are amassing data from your activity on their platforms, but that data concentrates heavily in your online behavior, such as searches made, photos uploaded, YouTube videos watched, and posts "liked." Chinese companies are instead gathering data from the real world: the what, when, and where of physical purchases, meals, makeovers, and transportation. Deep learning can only optimize what it can "see" by way of data, and China's physically grounded technology ecosystem gives these algorithms many more eyes into the content of our daily lives.

Notiz

Stelle: 1,091

For three of the four years leading up to 2014, total Chinese VC funding held steady at around $3 billion. In 2014, that immediately quadrupled to $12 billion, and then doubled again to $26 billion in 2015. Now it seemed like any smart and experienced young person with a novel idea and some technical chops could throw together a business plan and find funding to get his or her startup off the ground. American policy analysts and investors looked askance at this heavy-handed government intervention in what are supposed to be free and efficient markets. Private-sector players make better bets when it comes to investing, they said, and government-funded innovation zones or incubators will be inefficient, a waste of taxpayer money. In the minds of many Silicon Valley power players, the best thing that the federal government can do is leave them alone. But what these critics miss is that this process can be both highly inefficient and extraordinarily effective. When the long-term upside is so monumental, overpaying in the short term can be the right thing to do. The Chinese government wanted to engineer a fundamental shift in the Chinese economy, from manufacturing-led growth to innovation-led growth, and it wanted to do that in a hurry.

Notiz

Stelle: 1,183

With the rise of O2O, WeChat had grown into the title bestowed on it by Connie Chan of leading VC fund Andreesen Horowitz: a remote control for our lives. It had become a super-app, a hub for diverse functions that are spread across dozens of different apps in other ecosystems. In effect, WeChat has taken on the functionality of Facebook, iMessage, Uber, Expedia, eVite, Instagram, Skype, PayPal, Grubhub, Amazon, LimeBike, WebMD, and many more. It isn't a perfect substitute for any one of those apps, but it can perform most of the core functions of each, with frictionless mobile payments already built in.

Notiz

Stelle: 1,311

The IoT refers to collections of real-world, internet-connected devices that can convey data from the world around them to other devices in the network. Most Mobikes are equipped with solar-powered GPS, accelerators, Bluetooth, and near-field communications capabilities that can be activated by a smartphone. Together, those sensors generate twenty terabytes of data per day and feed it all back into Mobike's cloud servers.

Notiz

Stelle: 1,372

As artificial intelligence filters into the broader economy, this era will reward the quantity of solid AI engineers over the quality of elite researchers. Real economic strength in the age of AI implementation won't come just from a handful of elite scientists who push the boundaries of research. It will come from an army of well-trained engineers who team up with entrepreneurs to turn those discoveries into game-changing companies.

Notiz

Stelle: 1,436

When asked how far China lags behind Silicon Valley in artificial intelligence research, some Chinese entrepreneurs jokingly answer "sixteen hours"—the time difference between California and Beijing.

Notiz

Stelle: 1,494

There are valid critiques of China's system of governance, ones that weigh heavily on public debate and research in the social sciences. But when it comes to research in the hard sciences, these issues are not nearly as limiting as many outsiders presume. Artificial intelligence doesn't touch on sensitive political questions, and China's AI scientists are essentially as free as their American counterparts to construct cutting-edge algorithms or build profitable AI applications.

Notiz

Stelle: 1,533

In terms of funding, Google dwarfs even its own government: U.S. federal funding for math and computer science research amounts to less than half of Google's own R&D budget.

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Stelle: 1,535

Of the top one hundred AI researchers and engineers, around half are already working for Google.

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Stelle: 1,754

FIRST WAVE: INTERNET AI

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Stelle: 1,758

This first wave began almost fifteen years ago but finally went mainstream around 2012. Internet AI is largely about using AI algorithms as recommendation engines: systems that learn our personal preferences and then serve up content hand-picked for us.

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Stelle: 1,809

SECOND WAVE: BUSINESS AI

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Stelle: 1,811

Business AI takes advantage of the fact.

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Stelle: 1,848

Smart Finance, an AI-powered app that relies exclusively on algorithms to make millions of small loans. Instead of asking borrowers to enter how much money they make, it simply requests access to some of the data on a potential borrower's phone. That data forms a kind of digital fingerprint, one with an astonishing ability to predict whether the borrower will pay back a loan of three hundred dollars. Smart Finance's deep-learning algorithms don't just look to the obvious metrics, like how much money is in your WeChat Wallet. Instead, it derives predictive power from data points that would seem irrelevant to a human loan officer. For instance, it considers the speed at which you typed in your date of birth, how much battery power is left on your phone, and thousands of other parameters. What does an applicant's phone battery have to do with creditworthiness? This is the kind of question that can't be answered in terms of simple cause and effect. But that's not a sign of the limitations of AI. It's a sign of the limitations of our own minds at recognizing correlations hidden within massive streams of data. By training its algorithms on millions of loans—many that got paid back and some that didn't—Smart Finance has discovered thousands of weak features that are correlated to creditworthiness, even if those correlations can't be explained in a simple way humans can understand. Those offbeat metrics constitute what Smart Finance founder Ke Jiao calls "a new standard of beauty" for lending, one to replace the crude metrics of income, zip code, and even credit score.

Notiz

Stelle: 1,864

business AI can be about more than dollars and cents. When applied to other information-driven public goods, it can mean a massive democratization of high-quality services to those who previously couldn’t afford them. One of the most promising of these is medical diagnosis.

Notiz

Stelle: 1,892

iFlyTek has taken the lead in applying AI to the courtroom, building tools and executing a Shanghai-based pilot program that uses data from past cases to advise judges on both evidence and sentencing. An evidence cross-reference system uses speech recognition and natural-language processing to compare all evidence presented—testimony, documents, and background material—and seek out contradictory fact patterns. It then alerts the judge to these disputes, allowing for further investigation and clarification by court officers. Once a ruling is handed down, the judge can turn to yet another AI tool for advice on sentencing. The sentencing assistant starts with the fact pattern—defendant’s criminal record, age, damages incurred, and so on—then its algorithms scan millions of court records for similar cases. It uses that body of knowledge to make recommendations for jail time or fines to be paid. Judges can also view similar cases as data points scattered across an X–Y graph, clicking on each dot for details on the fact pattern that led to the sentence. It’s a process that builds consistency in a system with over 100,000 judges, and it can also rein in outliers whose sentencing patterns put them far outside the mainstream. One Chinese province is even using AI to rate and rank all prosecutors on their performance. Some American courts have implemented similar algorithms to advise on the “risk” level of prisoners up for parole, though the role and lack of transparency of these AI tools have already been challenged in higher courts.

Notiz

Stelle: 1,919

THIRD WAVE: PERCEPTION AI

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Stelle: 1,926

Third-wave AI is all about extending and expanding this power throughout our lived environment, digitizing the world around us through the proliferation of sensors and smart devices. These devices are turning our physical world into digital data that can then be analyzed and optimized by deep-learning algorithms.

Notiz

Stelle: 1,988

Perception AI–powered shopping trips like this will capture one of the fundamental contradictions of the AI age before us: it will feel both completely ordinary and totally revolutionary. Much of our daily activity will still follow our everyday established patterns, but the digitization of the world will eliminate common points of friction and tailor services to each individual.

Notiz

Stelle: 1,996

These kinds of immersive OMO scenarios go far beyond shopping. These same techniques—visual identification, speech recognition, creation of a detailed profile based on one's past behavior—can be used to create a highly tailored experience in education.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,103

FOURTH WAVE: AUTONOMOUS AI

Notiz

Stelle: 2,104

Autonomous AI represents the integration and culmination of the three preceding waves, fusing machines' ability to optimize from extremely complex data sets with their newfound sensory powers. Combining these superhuman powers yields machines that don't just understand the world around them—they shape it.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,220

Predicting which country takes the lead in autonomous AI largely comes down to one main question: will the primary bottleneck to full deployment be one of technology or policy? If the most intractable problems for deployment are merely technical ones, Google's Waymo has the best shot at solving them years ahead of the nearest competitor. But if new advances in fields like computer vision quickly disseminate throughout the industry—essentially, a rising technical tide lifting all boats—then Silicon Valley's head start on core technology may prove irrelevant. Many companies will become capable of building safe autonomous vehicles, and deployment will then become a matter of policy adaptation. In that universe, China's Tesla-esque policymaking will give its companies the edge.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,228

In the table below, I summarize my assessment of U.S. and Chinese capabilities across all four waves of AI, both in the present day and with my best estimate for how that balance will have evolved five years in the future.   The balance of capabilities between the United States and China across the four waves of AI, currently and estimated for five years in the future

Notiz

Stelle: 2,377

A college degree—even a highly specialized professional degree—is no guarantee of job security when competing against machines that can spot patterns and make decisions on levels the human brain simply can't fathom.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,390

The past few years have shown us how a cauldron of long-simmering inequality can boil over into radical political upheaval. I believe that, if left unchecked, AI will throw gasoline on the socioeconomic fires.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,421

In their landmark book The Second Machine Age, MIT professors Erik Brynjolfsson and Andrew McAfee described GPTs as the technologies that “really matter,” the ones that “interrupt and accelerate the normal march of economic progress.” Looking only at GPTs dramatically shrinks the number of data points available for evaluating technological change and job losses.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,480

The transition to an AI-driven economy will be far faster than any of the prior GPT-induced transformations, leaving workers and organizations in a mad scramble to adjust. Whereas the Industrial Revolution took place across several generations, the AI revolution will have a major impact within one generation. That’s because AI adoption will be accelerated by three catalysts that didn’t exist during the introduction of steam power and electricity. First, many productivity-increasing AI products are just digital algorithms: infinitely replicable and instantly distributable around the world.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,496

The second catalyst is one that many in the technology world today take for granted: the creation of the venture-capital industry.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,507

Finally, the third catalyst is one that’s equally obvious and yet often overlooked: China. Artificial intelligence will be the first GPT of the modern era in which China stands shoulder to shoulder with the West in both advancing and applying the technology.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,609

few, if any, experts predicted that deep learning was going to get this good, this fast. Those unexpected improvements are expanding the realm of the possible when it comes to real-world uses and thus job disruptions. One of the clearest examples of these accelerating improvements is the ImageNet competition. In the competition, algorithms submitted by different teams are tasked with identifying thousands of different objects within millions of different images, such as birds, baseballs, screwdrivers, and mosques. It has quickly emerged as one of the most respected image-recognition contests and a clear benchmark for AI’s progress in computer vision.

Notiz | Stelle: 2,613

Stelle: 2,736

As a technology and an industry, AI naturally gravitates toward monopolies. Its reliance on data for improvement creates a self-perpetuating cycle: better products lead to more users, those users lead to more data, and that data leads to even better products, and thus more users and data. Once a company has jumped out to an early lead, this kind of ongoing repeating cycle can turn that lead into an insurmountable barrier to entry for other firms.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,771

We could see the rapid emergence of a new corporate oligarchy, a class of AI-powered industry champions whose data edge over the competition feeds on itself until they are entirely untouchable. American antitrust laws are often difficult to enforce in this situation, because of the requirement in U.S. law that plaintiffs prove the monopoly is actually harming consumers. AI monopolists, by contrast, would likely be delivering better and better services at cheaper prices to consumers, a move made possible by the incredible productivity and efficiency gains of the technology.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,778

Driving income inequality will be the emergence of an increasingly bifurcated labor market. The jobs that do remain will tend to be either lucrative work for top performers or low-paying jobs in tough industries. The risk of replacement cited in the earlier figures reflects this. The most difficult jobs to automate—those in the top-right corner of the "Safe Zone"—include both ends of the income spectrum: CEOs and healthcare aides, venture capitalists and masseuses.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,798

AI risks creating a twenty-first-century caste system, one that divides the population into the AI elite and what historian Yuval N. Harari has crudely called the “useless class,” people who can never generate enough economic value to support themselves. Even worse, recent history has shown us just how fragile our political institutions and social fabric can be in the face of intractable inequality.

Notiz

Stelle: 2,804

In the centuries since the Industrial Revolution, we have increasingly come to see our work not just as a means of survival but as a source of personal pride, identity, and real-life meaning.

Notiz

Stelle: 3,237

As we transition from the industrial age to the AI age, we will need to move away from a mindset that equates work with life or treats humans as variables in a grand productivity optimization algorithm. Instead, we must move toward a new culture that values human love, service, and compassion more than ever

Notiz

Stelle: 3,348

The bleak predictions of broad unemployment and unrest have put many of the Silicon Valley elite on edge. People who have spent their careers preaching the gospel of disruption appear to have suddenly woken up to the fact that when you disrupt an industry, you also disrupt and displace real human beings within it. Having founded and funded transformative internet companies that also contributed to gaping inequality, this cadre of millionaires and billionaires appear determined to soften the blow in the age of AI. To these proponents, massive redistribution schemes are potentially all that stand between an AI-driven economy and widespread joblessness and destitution. Job retraining and clever scheduling are hopeless in the face of widespread automation, they argue. Only a guaranteed income will let us avert disaster during the jobs crisis that looms ahead.

Notiz

Stelle: 3,381

UBI is the epitome of the “light” approach to problem-solving so popular in the valley: stick to the purely digital sphere and avoid the messy details of taking action in the real world. It tends to envision that all problems can be solved through a tweaking of incentives or a shuffling of money between digital bank accounts.

Notiz

Stelle: 3,403

In the risk-of-replacement graphs from chapter 6, we expect to see the upper-left quadrant (“Human Veneer”) offer the greatest opportunity for human-AI symbiosis: AI will do the analytical thinking, while humans will wrap that analysis in warmth and compassion. In that same chart, the two quadrants on the right-hand side of the graph (“Slow Creep” and “Safe Zone”) also provide opportunities for AI tools to enhance creativity or decision-making, though over time, the two left-side AI-centric circles will grow toward the right as AI improves.   Human–AI coexistence in the labor market

Notiz

Stelle: 3,430

While compassionate caregivers will be well-trained, they can be drawn from a larger pool of workers than doctors and won’t need to undergo the years of rote memorization that is required of doctors today. As a result, society will be able to cost-effectively support far more compassionate caregivers than there are doctors, and we would receive far more and better care.

Notiz

Stelle: 3,433

Similar synergies will emerge in many other fields: teaching, law, event planning, and high-end retail.

Notiz

Stelle: 3,436

For those in professional sectors, it will be imperative that they adopt and learn to leverage AI tools as they arrive. As with any technological revolution, many workers will find the new tools both imperfect in their uses and potentially threatening in their implications. But these tools will only improve with time, and those who seek to compete against AI on its own terms will lose out. In the long run, resistance may be futile, but symbiosis will be rewarded.

Notiz

Stelle: 3,455

the free market alone will not be enough to offset the massive job losses and gaping inequality on the horizon. Private companies already create plenty of human-centered service jobs—they just don’t pay well. Economic incentives, public policies, and cultural dispositions have meant that many of the most compassion-filled professions existing today often lack job security or basic dignity.

Notiz

Stelle: 3,496

Driving those exponential returns are the unique economics of the internet. Digital products can be scaled up infinitely with near-zero marginal costs, meaning the most successful companies achieve astronomical profits. Service-focused impact investing, however, will need to be different. It will need to accept linear returns when coupled with meaningful job creation. That's because human-driven service jobs simply cannot achieve these exponential returns on investment. When someone builds a great company around human care work, they cannot digitally replicate these services and blast them out across the globe. Instead, the business must be built piece by piece, worker by worker. The truth is, traditional VCs wouldn't bother with these kinds of linear companies, but these companies will be a key pillar in building an AI economy that creates new jobs and fosters human connections.

Notiz

Stelle: 3,558

Just as those volunteers devoted their time and energy toward making their communities a little bit more loving, I believe it is incumbent on us to use the economic abundance of the AI age to foster these same values and encourage this same kind of activity. To do this, I propose we explore the creation not of a UBI but of what I call a social investment stipend. The stipend would be a decent government salary given to those who invest their time and energy in those activities that promote a kind, compassionate, and creative society. These would include three broad categories: care work, community service, and education.

Notiz

Stelle: 3,723

The AI programs that we’ve created have proven capable of mimicking and surpassing human brains at many tasks. As a researcher and scientist, I’m proud of these accomplishments. But if the original goal was to truly understand myself and other human beings, then these decades of “progress” got me nowhere. In effect, I got my sense of anatomy mixed up. Instead of seeking to outperform the human brain, I should have sought to understand the human heart.